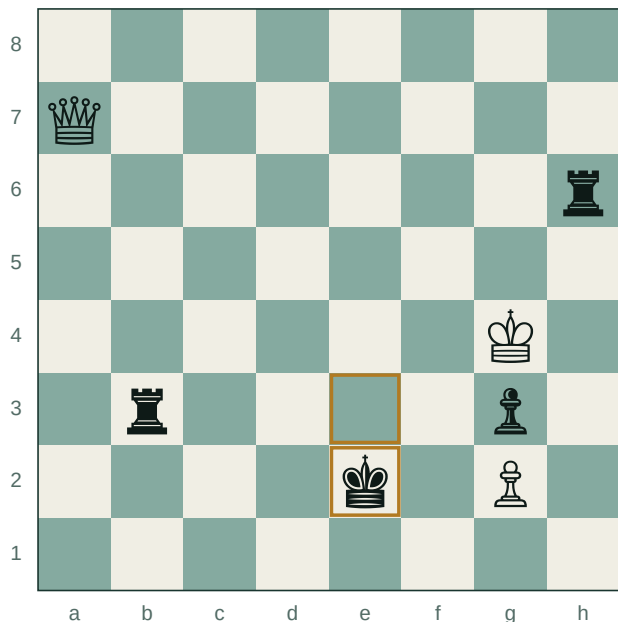


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 65

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 64...Ke2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

65. Qa2+ Ke3 66. Qxb3+

65.Qa2+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From a2 it attacks king on e2 and rook on b3. Recorded reply: **65...Ke3**.

66.Qxb3+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on b3.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e2. Geometrically undefended: rook on h6 and rook on b3. Check for tactical protection.